



August 2007

A Thanks For The Thankless!

Considering that there is a 50% probability that my letter be published, I'll write just a little about myself, lest people who read it come to know the state of the writer.

To be honest, I am no alpha geek. No, I don't know what 90% of files in the system32 folder do. But my life is under no evident threat (or I may be ignorant) for that. Like an average guy, I encounter technology the way you may expect me to, maybe a little more owing to my inquisitiveness. But a fan of the digital world, that I am. And thanks to *Digit*, proudly so. Every issue makes me realise how little I actually know and how much more there is. And I know how it feels to be ignorant as far as technology is concerned.

All this time, I've read the letters you receive from cynics, protagonists, fans, followers and critics. All go about the "stuff" you provide along with more "stuff" they'd like (your team tackles *all* letters with robust diplomacy, humility and honesty, I must say). But apart from the DVD, CD and *Fast Track*, I'd like to mention a few things.

I am more than glad for the computer info you provide, but what's more that makes an otherwise dreary, all-geeky article is the language you guys muster. *Awesome* is hardly the word for it. It is real fun to read the articles, the *Escape* section, and the rest of the mag - full of pun, humour and satire. Actually, I also learn a lot of *good* English from your magazine too. Thanks for that and keep up the amazing articles. For the digital part of life, I'm soulfully dependant on you, and satisfied *fully* with everything you are putting up. So no suggestions from me, except maybe: just keep rocking our gadget infested, mundane lives!

Siddhartha Mukherjee

Thanks, Siddhartha, for your kind remarks—especially from our copy editors! From what I understand, it is primarily them you're thanking—and it is primarily they who are responsible for quality control in terms of language, and little things like humour. (That's not to say their roles are limited to these functions, of course.)

A copy editor's (or sub-editor's) job is seldom appreciated, because they get no formal credit for anything they do—and rarely do they even get informal credit. It is, in general, a thankless job. Your mail has motivated them to buck up and keep up the good work—and I must thank you for that!

— Executive Editor

A Pal's Praise And Problem

I'm a regular reader of your excellent magazine. *Digit* is simply the best. I want to wish Team *Digit* a happy Friendship Day. If you're wondering why I'm wishing you, well, seriously, *Digit* is the best friend to guys like me who want to know more and more about technology. I live in a remote village in the eastern part of India where the use of technology is still a dream for most people. I face so much trouble to get simple software, and CDs or DVDs of games, music, and movies. I have to travel 10 km from my home to gain access to the Internet. I can't gain do that regularly, and an Internet connection to my PC is a dream in here. But in spite of this, I love to know more about technology, and you are who helps me a lot. That's why you are my best friend, and I'm sure we will be friends for a really long time!

In your August issue, you've mentioned that the price of the Nokia N73ME is Rs 24,349. I was planning to buy a good camera phone, so I went to a Nokia priority dealer. When I asked them about the N73ME, they told me the price was Rs 18,500, and when I told them about the price mentioned in *Digit*, they said the price you've mentioned was in the market five months ago, and that they'd reduced since then. I'm a bit confused.

Hirak Ghosh
Dist. Hooghly

We do our best to serve the needs of all our readers, but more so readers like you, who don't have easy access to technology and the Internet. Thanks for the appreciation, Hirak.

Regarding the price of the Nokia model you've mentioned, what we publish is the MRP (maximum retail price), which is consistent throughout the country. Dealers often quote the MOP (market operating price), which is affected

by local taxes, VAT, and other levies. Hence the discrepancy.

— Executive Editor

Faster, Higher, Stronger!

I wrote to you exactly two years ago. You published that letter in August '05 as the Letter of the Month. Much has happened since then. My hobby of assembling systems turned into a profession. I joined a small computer sales and service centre; I assembled systems as a hobby. I learnt networking. In 2006 we turned to importing PC hardware and marketing it only through dealer channels. We registered our own trademark and are marketing our own brand. We have mice, webcams, card readers, etc. Our stockists and distributors are spread all over India. I will soon be starting a cyber cafe.

You're probably wondering why I'm telling you all this. It's because *Digit* has been my guide and companion all these years. It has guided and taught me to build a career out of a hobby. I want to give credit where it is due.

I am still pursuing my creativity with hardware. In April '07, you showed us how to build a modded case. I'm thinking about starting work on one. But instead of using an old CRT, I've decided to use an old 0.8 tonne AC cabinet... I am currently experimenting with various flavours of Linux using Virtual Box. Thank you for keeping me young at 64 years of age.

D S Bapat

Dear Mr Bapat,
What can I say? All I can think of is that I've sent out your mail to my team, and it has been appreciated as hugely motivating. Thank you.

— Executive Editor

Misunderstanding Notwithstanding...

Digit is my technology friend, philosopher, guide, and my Guru. But this is about the August 2007 Inbox. I'm referring to the letter by Navin D'Cunha and your reply. It is interesting and surprising!

Navin has rightly pointed out the wonderful cover of the July '07 issue of *Digit*. He wrote: "...the cover left me with a pleasant feeling, at the same time surprising me." Most of us had that feeling. This is certainly an appreciative note, and there is absolutely nothing negative about it. He continues his words, very simple and honest. But it looks that you, in your reply, were confused and offensive. Navin's comments are highly